

Akhilesh Thite

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Education

University of California Santa Cruz

Masters of Science : Computer Science and Engineering

Sept 2024 - (Expected) June 2026

Graduate Teaching Assistant CSE 185

Terna Engineering College

Bachelor of Engineering : Computer Engineering

Aug 2019 - June 2023

Work Experience

Founder, Lead Developer - P2P Labs

Feb 2022 - Present

- Open-source, decentralized, user-owned software with **2000+** active owners.
- Building curated infrastructure tools for the decentralized web, based on p2p protocols. One of the main projects for this is **PeerSky**, a P2P local-first offline web browser.
- Successfully secured and efficiently utilized **devgrants** totaling **\$15,000** from Protocol Labs.

Google Summer of Code Mentor - UCSC OSPO

Feb 2025 - Sep 2025

- Mentored a contributor on PeerSky Browser, guiding development on customized browser settings, theme creation, and Chrome Web Extension integration.

Mobile Application Engineer Intern - IdentiKey

July 2025 - Aug 2025

- Designed and implemented secure key recovery, P2P onboarding, and verifiable credential flows in a cross-platform React Native app with 4-factor authentication.

Software Developer Intern - okTurtles Foundation

June 2025 - Aug 2025

Worked on **Chelonia**, an end-to-end encrypted, open-source, and federated framework built on **Shelter Protocol**.

- Implemented 'chel serve' by migrating 30,000+ lines of JavaScript to TypeScript across 170+ files, transforming the Chelonia CLI backend to a production-ready developer platform.
- Implemented 'chel pin' contract pinning with per-contract pinning capabilities, enabling independent contract lifecycle management and reducing deployment complexity.
- Built a TodoMVC example demonstrating Chelonia's contract architecture, serving as a reference implementation for developers.
- Modernized codebase infrastructure by migrating to Deno 2.0, implementing ESLint standards, and establishing robust CLI command structure.

Software Engineer - Distributed Systems - hypha.coop

Aug 2023 - Aug 2024

- Worked as part of the **Distributed Press** team to develop and implement features utilizing a **half-million-dollar** grant funded by **FFDW**, enabling Distributed Press-published websites to engage with the expansive Fediverse community, comprising over **10 million+** users across platforms like Mastodon and PixelFed.
- Played a key role in development and implementation of the **Social Inbox**, a pioneering tool that integrates social interaction capabilities into websites on the decentralized web.
- Implemented ActivityPub standards to facilitate follow requests, replies, and content updates, transforming websites into dynamic social profiles.
- Developed **Social Reader**, a P2P and offline ActivityPub client for reading and following microblogs on the Fediverse.
- Developed **DP-CLI**, a command-line tool enabling publishers to manage and publish decentralized websites, and interact with the Fediverse via ActivityPub.

Independent Web3 Developer, Hackathons

Feb 2021 - Jun 2023

- Solo hacker, **8x** Web3 hackathon winnings, **3x** devgrants.

Full Stack Blockchain Developer Intern - Cykura

Aug 2021 - Sep 2021

- Cykura was the first AMM on Solana to utilize Concentrated Liquidity.
- Worked on a custom price indexer, built a GraphQL API to fetch real-time market prices from Serum with the help of Serum's TS SDK.
- Added multiple wallet support to serum **swap-UI** with the help of Solana wallet-adaptor library.
- Worked on swap UI with the help of React Material-UI framework.

Projects

DTube: Decentralized video sharing & social media platform on Ethereum blockchain, **code**.

COVID-19 Vaccine Finder: check the available slots for vaccination centres from coWIN API in India (it was used by **thousands** during the COVID-19 pandemic to find available vaccine slots), **code**.

Planetary Albedo: A deep multi-objective regression model that can predict the chemical composition of Mercury & Moon, **code**.

Skills

Languages: JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, Solidity, HTML, CSS

Lib/Frameworks: Node.js, Deno, React.js, React Native, Electron.js, Flask

Protocols: IPFS, ActivityPub, Hypercore, BitTorrent, Ethereum

Databases: IndexedDB, SQLite

Tools & Platforms: Git, AWS (EC2)

Awards

- **Mar 2025: First Generation Graduate Research and Travel Award** - Awarded by the University of California, Santa Cruz for academic excellence and research impact as a first-generation graduate student to present work at a conference.
- **Mar 2025: People's Choice Speaker** - Awarded the Peoples Choice Speaker at ETHDenver, a community-nominated honor recognizing top voices from over **2,000+** submissions.
- **Oct 2024: Center For Research in Open Source Software (CROSS) Prize** - Peersky Browser was awarded **\$500** in the Open Source Track at the UCSC Ideathon.
- **Sep 2024: GitHub Universe Scholarship** - Awarded a complimentary General Admission ticket valued at **\$1300** to attend GitHub Universe 2024.
- **Jun 2023: Global DWeb Fellow & Speaker** - Awarded the DWeb **fellowship** for **DWeb Camp 2023**. Recognized as one of the **youngest** fellows in the cohort.
- **Apr 2023: IPFS Community Impact Awards Q2'23** - DScan Extension was **recognized** at the **IPFS Thing** event in Brussels as a recipient of an IPFS Community Impact Award.
- **Feb 2023: Mantle Mash Hackathon Winner** - Won a bounty worth **\$2500** for the Developer Infrastructure & Tooling track.
- **Oct 2022: IPFS Scholar** - Awarded the IPFS Scholarship in recognition of significant contributions to the IPFS ecosystem, enabling attendance and knowledge sharing at IPFS Camp 2022 in Lisbon, Portugal.
- **Mar 2022: Across the Line Award Faber Web3 Hackathon** - Received runner-up award worth **\$1000** for the Filecoin & IPFS track. Built the **DHost** VS Code Extension.
- **Nov 2021: MARS Asia Hackathon 2nd Prize** - Received 2nd prize worth **\$5000** for the Filecoin & IPFS Decentralization track. Developed the **DScan** Chrome extension.
- **Nov 2021: Polygon BUIDL IT Hackathon Runner-Up** - Achieved Top 40 on Polygon worth **\$500** and Top 20 on Filecoin & IPFS worth **\$250**. Created an **NFT ticketing** marketplace on the Polygon Blockchain.
- **Aug 2021: Polygon Learn Tutorial Reward** - Received a reward worth **\$1000** for writing the educational articles on Polygon.
- **Aug 2021: ETHOdyssey Hackathon 3rd Prize** - Secured 3rd prize worth **\$500** for the Filecoin & IPFS track. Developed **DTube**, a decentralized video sharing & social media platform on the Ethereum blockchain.
- **Feb 2021: IPFS Bounty Winner at ETHDenver Hackathon** - Won a **\$100** IPFS bounty for our project focused on AI-generated NFTs on the Ethereum blockchain.
- **Aug 2020 - Apr 2021: Notebooks Expert - Kaggle** - Achieved the highest rank of **1232** out of 300,000+ participants with 1 gold, 1 silver, and 3 bronze medals for notebooks, accumulating over **37,000+** views.